

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Owner driving backlog clarity and sprint discipline.*

Positioning, 13 years owning product backlogs in regulated industries, delivering software from user story to production across distributed teams.

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§ WHY 4MK SOLUTIONS

The role sits at the intersection I know best: translating client needs into a backlog the development team can actually execute. The posting calls out analytics projects specifically, which matches my work building a national labour-market analytics platform at Bundesagentur für Arbeit and an AI data platform for the FCAS defence programme. Managing release content, sprint priorities, and stakeholder expectations across a global project is how I have worked for the past several years. *That combination of technical credibility and client-facing communication is where I do my best work.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case review
- **GitHub Copilot**, daily coding support
- **Cursor**, code navigation and refactors
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations
- **Jira + Confluence**, backlog and sprint management
- **Figma / Miro**, requirement workshops and flows
- **GPT**, research and draft review

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, CI/CD pipelines, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT 4MK SOLUTIONS

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Read existing backlog items and sprint histories, sit in on client calls, and map the current requirements flow from intake to acceptance so I understand where handoffs break.

WEEK 2

Align and tighten.

Run a backlog refinement session with the development team to close ambiguous acceptance criteria, align on definition of done, and set a sprint cadence that matches actual team velocity.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Take the first sprint through planning, daily stand-ups, review, and retrospective, accept or reject delivered items against agreed criteria, and report release content back to the client.

I COVER LETTER

Dear 4MK Solutions team,

I am applying for the Senior Product Owner role. I have 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, insurance, public-sector analytics, healthcare, defence, and payments, and the work you describe maps closely to how I have operated across all of them.

The role asks for someone who can gather functional requirements from clients, write user stories, manage the product backlog, and keep the development team focused sprint by sprint. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a backlog a five-person team could not deliver. I cut it to the

top 10% of items against agreed success measures and user acceptance rose more than fivefold. At EMIL Group, an 18-person delivery organisation was losing client trust; I restructured it into three lean teams with their own leads and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production in the same period. In both cases the work was exactly what this posting describes: align with stakeholders, write and rank the backlog, run Scrum ceremonies, accept or reject work against clear criteria.

Your requirement for experience with analytics projects also fits directly. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform, introduced Dagster and dbt to remove manual steps from quarterly imports, and saved nearly 75% of the time per data update. At Rohde & Schwarz I managed the AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by redirecting strategy based on user workflow analysis. Both roles required me to hold the technical and the business conversation at the same time, exactly the liaison function this role describes.

I write and speak English at C2 level and have worked in international, distributed teams throughout my career. I am comfortable reporting to executives and to technical leads in the same day.

I would be glad to walk you through any of these projects in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Senior Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries including insurance, public-sector analytics, healthcare, payments, and defence AI. I gather requirements from clients and stakeholders, write user stories and acceptance criteria, manage the product backlog, and lead cross-functional teams through Scrum and Kanban. I communicate clearly at every level, from engineering stand-ups to executive steering committees.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.

- On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Spearheaded development of the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the backlog to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: the digital anamnesis went from 30 minutes to 5 from form to database.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from a near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

- Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems. Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

- Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

- Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop. Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - PRESENT

- Construction staffing, two-sided B2B marketplace. Zero to one alone: LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the day-to-day. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile P2P payments. Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, daily stand-up, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning, WIP limits.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, SQL.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, Insurance domain (EMIL Group B2B SaaS), stakeholder management, C-level reporting, budget ownership.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

LinkedIn · GitHub · www.true-north.berlin · YouTube (EN sample)
